Reimagining Agriculture in the Digital Economy

How AI, emerging technologies and digital platforms are changing how we farm, sell and build agricultural businesses.

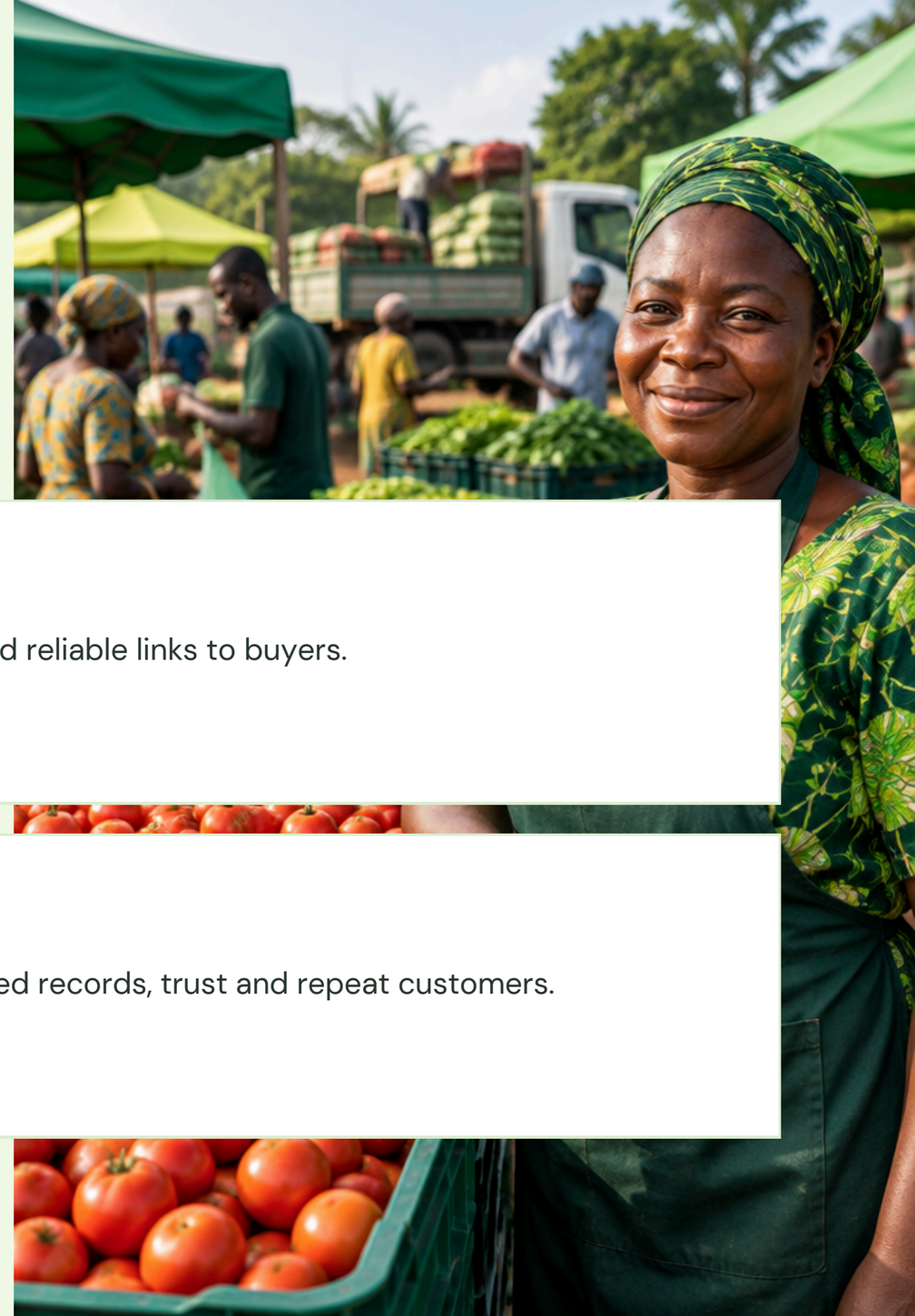
Barnabas Omoniwa (SirBarna)
Agriculture × Blockchain Researcher

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If agriculture matters so much, why is building a profitable business still hard?

Production is only one part of the challenge.



Produce

A good harvest does not guarantee a good sale.

Connect

Producers need reliable links to buyers.

Inform

Useful information must reach people in time.

Grow

Businesses need records, trust and repeat customers.

Agriculture is a value chain, not just a farm

Value is created before, during and after production.



Five problems technology may help solve

Start with the problem. Choose the technology second.

01 Information

Weather, prices and production guidance.

02 Production

Resource use and operational decisions.

03 Post-harvest

Storage, handling and processing.

04 Markets

Finding buyers and coordinating sales.

05 Business systems

Records, inventory and customer follow-up.

Five technology areas reshaping agriculture

Different tools solve different problems.

AI

Analysis, content and decision support.

IoT

Sensors for soil, water and climate.

Drones

Field observation and mapping.

Blockchain

Shared records and traceability.

Digital platforms

Management and market access.



AI in agriculture: from hype to practical use

AI can support work. It does not replace local knowledge or verification.

OPERATIONS Organize records and support planning.

CROP OBSERVATION Structure symptoms and research questions.

BUSINESS Draft budgets from supplied data.

MARKETING Generate content ideas and draft replies.

One farm. Five practical AI workflows.

Live demonstration • hypothetical tomato farm • Ogun State

01 Organize records

Production and sales in one clean structure.

02 Build a template

Track expenses consistently.

03 Research customers

Explore likely buyer needs.

04 Plan content

Draft a useful weekly rhythm.

05 Connect enquiry to order

Make follow-up repeatable.

Smart farming starts with useful data

Collect information that can improve a decision.

SOIL + WATER
Monitor moisture and irrigation needs.

GREENHOUSES
Track temperature and humidity.

FIELD MAPPING
Observe crop variation.

PLANNING
Combine observations with weather information.



Blockchain in agriculture: where does it fit?

Evaluate the use case, not the hype.

Traceability

Document product movements from one participant to the next.

Transactions

Support digital payments and records where appropriate.

Coordination

Share records among participants who need a common view.



Good produce needs a route to the customer

Production creates the product. Marketing helps connect it to buyers.

KNOW Understand the target customer.

EXPLAIN Communicate product value.

SIMPLIFY Make ordering clear.

BUILD TRUST Show reliable practices.

RETAIN Make repeat purchases easy.

Five content types agricultural businesses can use

Every post should serve a purpose.

Educate

Explain how a product is grown or stored.

Show

Take people behind the scenes.

Sell

Share availability and ordering details.

Build trust

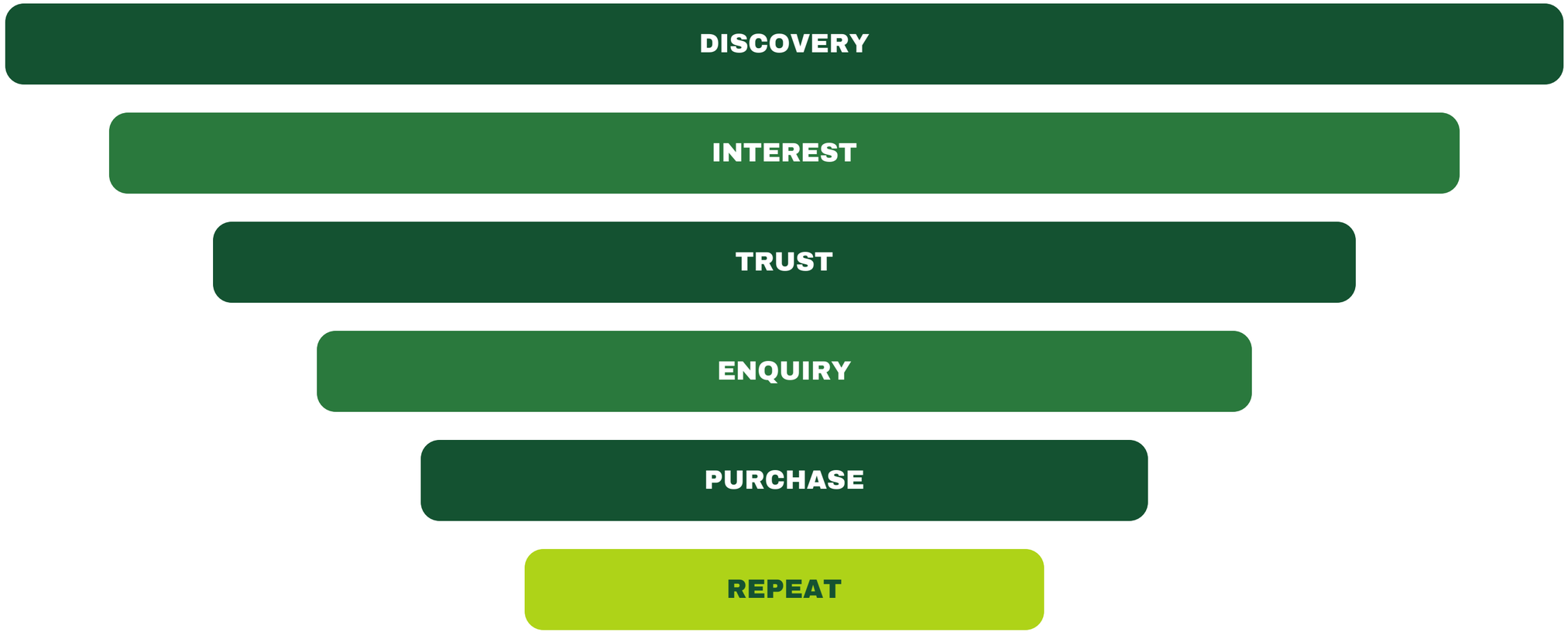
Show quality checks and order handling.

Answer

Respond to common customer questions.

From views to sales

Attention is not the same as revenue.



The digital agricultural opportunity map

People can create value across the value chain.

AI + automation

Business workflows and information support.

Content + marketing

Video, storytelling and customer acquisition.

Data + software

Reporting, management tools and digital products.

Research + blockchain

Technology evaluation and traceability.



You don't have to own a farm to contribute

Start from the skills you have, then learn the sector.

FARMER
Improve records and market access.

STUDENT
Pair agricultural knowledge with a digital skill.

ENTREPRENEUR
Test a real solution.

TECH PROFESSIONAL
Apply technical skills to agricultural needs.

Nigerian agri funding in 2026: what has closed

Funding comes in windows. Prepare before they open.

Lagos Agrithon

₦200 million pool • closed 19 July.

iDICE Startup Bridge — Cohort 2

Up to ₦10 million • closed 26 July.

FCMB × FMO × Heave AgriTech

Up to ₦20 million • closed 21 August • Demo Day 5 November.

Orange Corners Nigeria

Innovation Challenge for Lagos and Ogun graduates • closed 20 October.

What is open, and what to prepare for

BANK OF AGRICULTURE
Renewed Hope programme

Expression of interest for aggregator companies with 3+ years' experience and ₦500 million turnover. Farmers can benefit by working with an accredited aggregator.

Check boanig.com/rh-shf for the deadline.

TONY ELUMELU FOUNDATION

USD 5,000 seed capital. More than 265,000 applied in 2026. The window ran January to about March.

Prepare now and check for 2027.

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Always confirm details on the official application page.

Sources: BOA, TechCabal, Techpoint, Tony Elumelu Foundation and organiser flyers.

Check every grant before you apply

Fake grants are spreading on blogs, LinkedIn and Facebook.

1 Find the real website

Start with the organisation's official domain.

2 Search the site

Look for the announcement on the official site.

3 Compare the details

Check amounts and dates across independent sources.

RED FLAG EXAMPLE A fake “IFC Agritech Modernization Grant” of up to USD 2.5 million circulated in 2026. A fraud watchdog flagged it; it does not appear on IFC's real site.

Don't start with an app. Start with a problem.

A simple path from idea to useful solution.

1 IDENTIFY
What specific problem exists?

2 INVESTIGATE
Who has it—and what do they do today?

3 TEST
Can a simple tool or service help?

4 MEASURE
Did it create value?

Your first 30 days

A small test beats a big plan that never starts.

WEEK 1

Choose one agricultural problem.

WEEK 2

Talk to users and observe current workarounds.

WEEK 3

Test one tool or simple solution.

WEEK 4

Review results and document learning.

Let's talk about the problems that matter

Your experience is part of the conversation.

01 What is the biggest problem

...in your area of agriculture?

02 Which digital tool

...could make the most difference?

03 What stops farmers

...from adopting useful technology?

04 What opportunity

...should young people explore?



The future needs people who can connect the dots

Agricultural knowledge + useful technology + practical execution

What problem will you help solve?

Research and sources: agri-blockchain-hub.vercel.app
Barnabas Omoniwa (SirBarna)